

ICAS

PAPER

A



2017 ENGLISH

**DO NOT OPEN THIS BOOKLET
UNTIL INSTRUCTED.**

45 QUESTIONS

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

STUDENT'S NAME:

Read the instructions on the **ANSWER SHEET** and fill in your **NAME, SCHOOL** and **OTHER INFORMATION**.

Use a pencil. Do **NOT** use a coloured pencil or a pen.

Rub out any mistakes completely.

You **MUST** record your answers on the **ANSWER SHEET**.

Mark only **ONE** answer for each question.

Your score will be the number of correct answers.

Marks are **NOT** deducted for incorrect answers.

There are **45 MULTIPLE-CHOICE QUESTIONS** (1–45).

Use the information provided to choose the **BEST** answer from the four possible options.

On your **ANSWER SHEET** fill in the oval that matches your answer.

Questions may sometimes be placed next to each other. Make sure you read **ACROSS** the page and answer the questions in the correct order.

You are **NOT** allowed to use a dictionary or an electronic translator.

Treasure

‘Come closer, we have a secret to tell you,’ said Ma and Pa Farmer. Up close, Jake and Sal could see that their grandparents’ skin was crumpled and wrinkled like fingers left too long in water.

‘There’s treasure on our farm,’ said Pa Farmer, ‘but you need to work hard to see it.’



Jake and Sal looked at each other. The word ‘treasure’ lit up their eyes but they didn’t want to work for it. They were visiting from the city and were not used to hard farm work. Was there another way?

‘No,’ said Ma Farmer. ‘You have to work in the fields and plant the seeds if you want to get the treasure. There is no other way.’



And so Jake and Sal started digging. They dug up the nearest field until it was covered in soft, powdery earth. They planted seeds as they dug. But there was no treasure. So they started digging up the other fields, one at a time, and planted more seeds. All the fields were now rich, brown and wriggling with worms. After their days of hard work, Jake and Sal sat with throbbing backs, blistered hands and bowed heads. It was clear the treasure they were looking for was not there at all.

‘The treasure is there,’ said Pa Farmer. ‘We promise that you’ll see it the next time you visit.’

Four months later, Jake and Sal visited Ma and Pa Farmer again. They saw fields of golden wheat, the tall stalks dancing to greet them. The slender heads of wheat waved as if they were saying hello.

‘The golden fields you see come from the seeds you planted and now we have food to eat. Remember Pa and I said you would have to work for the treasure? Do you see it now?’

At last Jake and Sal understood the meaning of their grandparents’ advice.



1. Who is in this picture?



- (A) Pa Farmer
(B) Ma Farmer
(C) Jake
(D) Sal
2. At the beginning of the story, why did Ma and Pa Farmer tell Jake and Sal to come closer?
- (A) to show the children the treasure
(B) to look at the children carefully
(C) to show the children their hands
(D) to tell the children a secret
3. What was Ma and Pa Farmer's skin compared to?
- (A) fingers which were old
(B) paper which was crumpled up
(C) fingers which had been in water for a long time
(D) water which had ripples on the surface
4. 'Was there another way?'
Jake and Sal wondered if there was another way to
- (A) get the treasure.
(B) work for the treasure.
(C) answer Pa Farmer.
(D) visit the farm.
5. 'After their days of hard work, Jake and Sal sat with throbbing backs, blistered hands and bowed heads.'
The words 'bowed heads' show that Jake and Sal felt
- (A) angry that they had to work so hard.
(B) happy that the work was finished.
(C) disappointed that they had not found the treasure.
(D) bored by the treasure hunt.
6. What was the treasure?
- (A) the crop of wheat
(B) Jake and Sal's hard work
(C) patience and time
(D) Ma and Pa's advice

A short (but sweet!) history of marshmallows

Who *doesn't* like marshmallows? What's not to like in those soft, powdered, chewy, little pillows of sweetness? But the next time you find yourself dropping a couple into your hot chocolate or, even better, toasting them over a crackling camp fire, think about that humble marshmallow before you pop it into your mouth. What do you actually know about it? Where did it come from?

Well, would it surprise you to know that the original main ingredient came from a plant called mallow that grew in swamps and marshes?

The healing powers of marsh mallow

Mallow is a hardy plant that is widespread in Europe and Asia. The marsh mallow plant is a variety that thrives in coastal areas and marshes and has the official name *Althaea officinalis*. The first part of its name, *Althaea*, means 'to heal'. The plant has been widely used for its medicinal and healing properties for thousands of years. The leaves, roots, flowers and fruit were all used extensively in creating potions, syrups and creams to heal skin sores and infections, sore throats and digestive disorders. It was also commonly eaten as a vegetable.



The Marsh Mallow Plant
(*Althaea officinalis*)

Marshmallows as a sweet treat

It was the Ancient Egyptians who thought of using the marsh mallow plant to make sweets. They painstakingly extracted the syrupy sap from the root of the mallow plant and mixed it with honey and nuts to create a soft, chewy sweet. It was a time-consuming process which meant that it became a delicacy only enjoyed by royalty.

French confectioners in the 1800s improved on the recipe. They whipped the sap until it was light and fluffy and added sugar to create a lighter, fluffier sweet, more like the marshmallows we enjoy today. Its popularity boomed but the extraction of the sap took a long time and marshmallows couldn't be produced quickly enough to satisfy demand. By the end of the century, the sap had been replaced with ingredients that were easier to obtain: egg white and gelatine.

In the 1900s, marshmallows were made with machines ensuring the availability of marshmallows for all. Hooray!

Stoke up the fire and let's get toasting.

7. 'Who *doesn't* like marshmallows?'
- The writer asks this question to suggest that
- (A) not many people like marshmallows.
 - (B) people eat too many marshmallows.
 - (C) marshmallows are a popular sweet.
 - (D) marshmallows have an interesting history.
8. Which underlined word in this quotation is a noun?
- 'those soft, powdered, chewy, little pillows'
- (A) (B) (C) (D)
9. The word 'widespread' means that the marsh mallow plant
- (A) is found over a large area.
 - (B) grows quickly in the correct location.
 - (C) is well-known in Europe and Asia.
 - (D) grows in swamps and marshes.
10. The words '*Althaea officinalis*' are written in *italics* to show that it is the marsh mallow plant's
- (A) translated name.
 - (B) old-fashioned name.
 - (C) scientific name.
 - (D) common name.
11. The Ancient Egyptians were the first to use the marsh mallow plant as a
- (A) lotion.
 - (B) vegetable.
 - (C) medicine.
 - (D) sweet.
12. 'it became a delicacy only enjoyed by royalty'
- In this sentence the word 'enjoyed' means that only royalty
- (A) produced marshmallows.
 - (B) ate marshmallows.
 - (C) traded marshmallows.
 - (D) improved marshmallows.
13. What happened in the 1900s that meant more people could buy marshmallows?
- (A) There was an increase in demand.
 - (B) Egg whites replaced mallow sap.
 - (C) Machines were able to make greater amounts.
 - (D) Ingredients became easier to find.

Read the text and answer the questions that follow.

Wobbly

Sonny was thoughtfully wiggling a tooth when his mum came up to call him for dinner.

'It's still wobbly,' he said gloomily.

'It'll fall out when it's ready,' said Mum. 'Just forget about it.'

'I've tried,' said Sonny, 'but my tongue finds it and wiggles it anyway.'

Sonny was actually getting quite worried. He half wished it wouldn't fall out. Having a wobbly tooth was one thing, but he couldn't begin to imagine what it would be like to have a hole instead. Surely it would hurt, possibly quite a lot. It might stay sore. It might bleed for days! Sonny was a bit disappointed that his parents were taking it all so calmly.

He thought about Emma next door. She'd lost two teeth together. Two! Where did it stop? What if *all* his teeth fell out? He'd look so weird! And what would he eat? Jelly for every meal?

'Forget about it,' repeated Mum as they went downstairs. 'Dad's made your favourite.'

The smell of fresh pizza filled the kitchen and Sonny smiled for the first time all day.

'This will cheer you up,' said Dad.

Sonny bit into the crust of the hot slice of pepperoni pizza. 'Yumm ... that's perfect,' he said grinning widely.

Sonny's Mum and Dad grinned too as they high-fived each other.

'Job done!' they said in unison.

Sonny looked at them, confused. He hadn't noticed that his tooth was gone.



Children are born with no teeth.



By the time they are 3 years old, children have 20 'milk' teeth.



Between the ages of 6 and 12, all the milk teeth fall out. It doesn't hurt.



Milk teeth are replaced by 28 permanent teeth. These are bigger and harder. Take care of them and they will last forever.



Some people get another 4 teeth, called 'wisdom teeth,' between the ages of 17 and 25. These would give them 32 teeth in total.

14. 'Sonny was a bit disappointed that his parents were taking it all so calmly.'
Why did his parents remain so calm?
- (A) They were worried about the tooth but hid it from him.
 - (B) They remembered that he had lost a tooth before.
 - (C) They were unaware that he had a loose tooth.
 - (D) They knew that losing a tooth was a normal event.
15. Alliteration is the repetition of the same sound at the beginning of words that are close together. Which quotation is an example of alliteration?
- (A) 'my tongue finds it and wiggles it'
 - (B) 'She'd lost two teeth together'
 - (C) 'Jelly for every meal?'
 - (D) 'they high-fived each other'
16. When Sonny's parents said, 'Job done!', what 'job' were they referring to?
- (A) getting Sonny out of his room
 - (B) creating the perfect pizza
 - (C) getting their son to eat some dinner
 - (D) helping Sonny's tooth fall out
17. Which of Sonny's fears about losing a tooth happened?
- (A) There was a gap where the tooth had been.
 - (B) It was very painful for a long time.
 - (C) There was a lot of blood after his tooth fell out.
 - (D) He could only eat soft foods.
18. According to the text, which statement about teeth is correct?
- (A) Babies are born with 20 milk teeth.
 - (B) Adults usually have 28 permanent teeth.
 - (C) The 28 permanent teeth are replaced by 20 milk teeth.
 - (D) All adults get wisdom teeth.
19. What is the purpose of the writing in these boxes  ?
- (A) to give some facts about teeth
 - (B) to offer general advice about dental care
 - (C) to provide a list of instructions for Sonny
 - (D) to continue the story

For each question, choose the option CLOSEST IN MEANING to the underlined word.

The flock

Clara was looking out her window one day when she saw a huge black shadow pass over her house. (20) Startled, she opened the door and looked outside. Suddenly the shadow (21) swept down over her head and she saw that it was a flock of birds! She ran back inside to tell her grandfather. 'The whole sky, Grandpa!' she said, smiling. 'The whole sky is filled with birds!' It was (22) exhilarating.

20. (A) Impressed
(B) Nervous
(C) Brave
(D) Shocked
21. (A) glided
(B) jumped
(C) dropped
(D) floated
22. (A) lively
(B) thrilling
(C) educational
(D) interesting

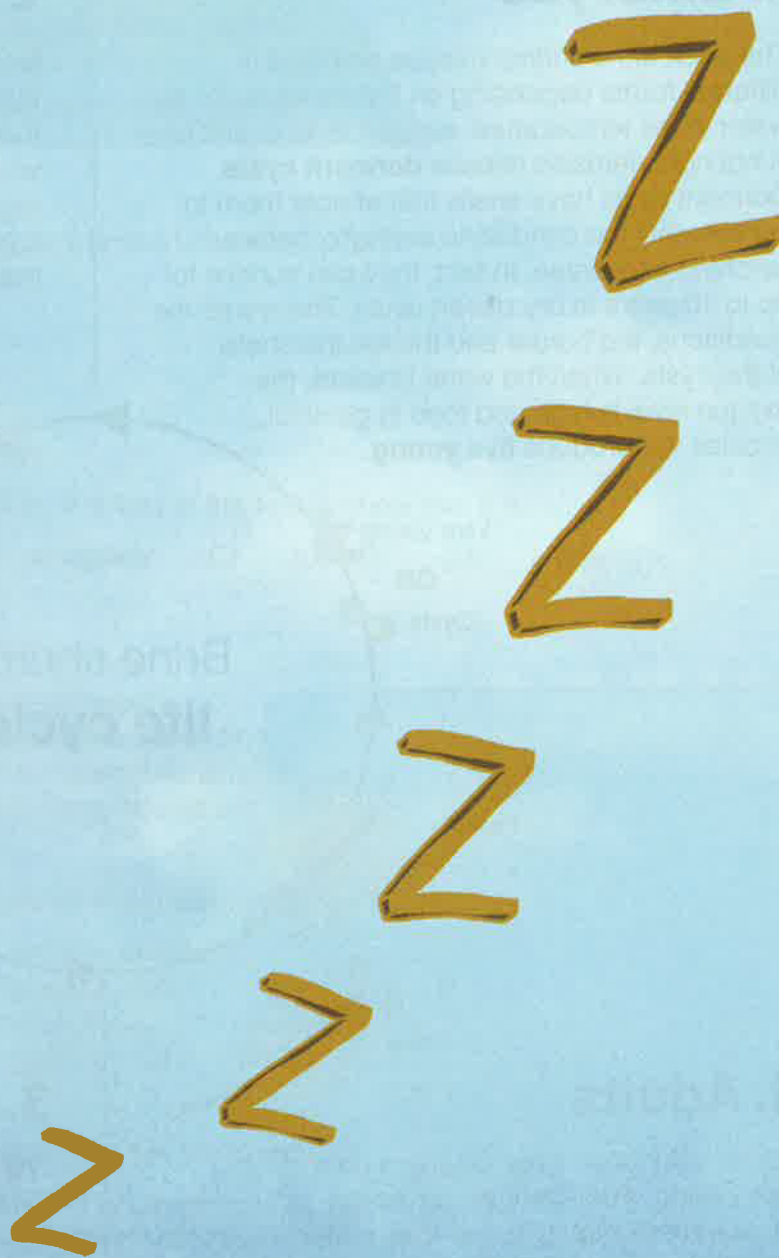


For each question, choose the correct option to complete the text.

SLEEP

Sleep is something all people have to do. Animals need sleep too. When we sleep, our bodies get a chance to take a rest (23) all the busy things we do while we are awake. But that does not mean that we (24) doing anything while we are asleep. Can you think of anything people or animals do (25) they are sleeping?

23. (A) with
(B) from
(C) to
(D) of
24. (A) are not
(B) cannot be
(C) should not be
(D) have not been
25. (A) and
(B) while
(C) but
(D) yet



Read the text and answer the questions that follow.

Brine shrimp life cycle

Brine shrimp are distant relatives of shrimp, crabs and lobsters. Like these creatures, brine shrimp are crustaceans, which means they have a hard but flexible shell (exoskeleton) for protection. Brine shrimp shed their exoskeleton 14 to 17 times as they grow. An adult reaches approximately 15 millimetres in length. In natural conditions they eat microscopic algae (plants) in salt lakes and live for about four months. Humans use brine shrimp as live food for aquariums and fish farms.



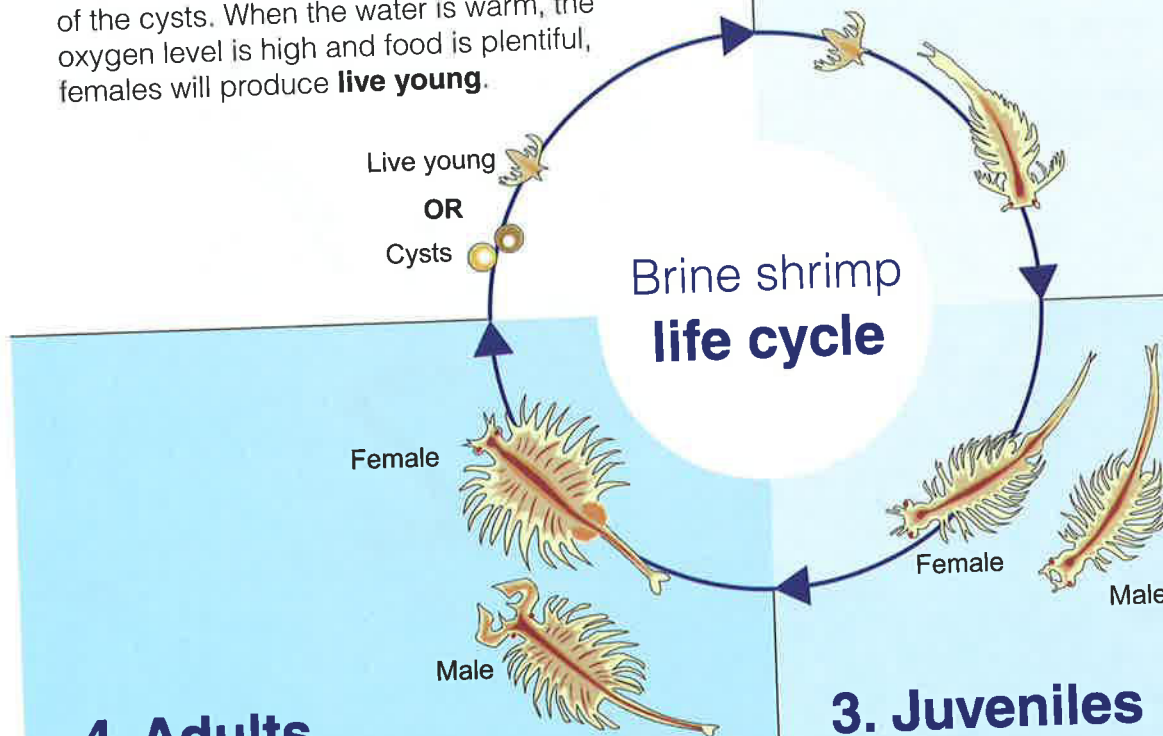
Hands holding brine shrimp.

1. Embryos

The adult brine shrimp release embryos in different forms depending on the condition of the water. If the temperature, oxygen level or salt level is not right, females release **dormant cysts**. Dormant cysts have shells that enable them to survive until the conditions are right, before hatching into larvae. In fact, they can survive for up to 10 years in dry desert lakes. The worse the conditions, the harder and thicker the shells of the cysts. When the water is warm, the oxygen level is high and food is plentiful, females will produce **live young**.

2. Larvae

Brine shrimp larvae are called nauplii (NAW-plee-ee). They have single eyes to help them move towards the light to find food. At first, young nauplii use their antennae to swim and catch food. But as their legs grow, they use their legs instead. They also use gills on their legs to breathe. Later on, nauplii grow two more eyes.



4. Adults

Adult males have large claspers on their heads. Adult females have egg sacs and are slightly larger than males. Females can produce up to 300 nauplii every four days.

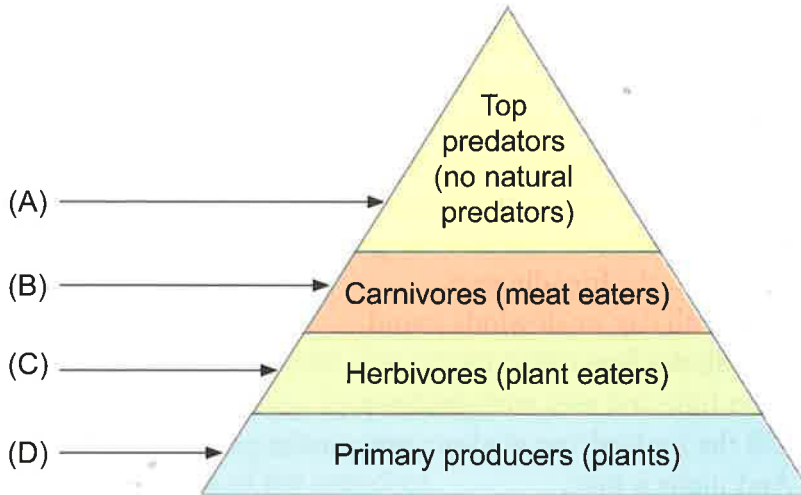
3. Juveniles

The antennae of young brine shrimp shrink as their 11 pairs of legs grow. The differences between males and females become more obvious as they grow.

26. What do brine shrimp have in common with shrimp, crabs and lobsters?

- (A) All live in freshwater lakes.
- (B) All have protective shells.
- (C) All live for a long time.
- (D) All eat tiny animals.

27. According to the text, where would brine shrimp fit on this diagram?



28. According to the text, what do people use brine shrimp for?

- (A) as bait to catch fish
- (B) as aquarium pets
- (C) as food for fish
- (D) as food to eat

29. The word **Embryos** is written this way in the text to show that it is

- (A) a subheading.
- (B) a caption.
- (C) a label.
- (D) a title.

30. Female brine shrimp produce

- (A) live young if food is in short supply.
- (B) hard-shelled eggs that hatch in a few days.
- (C) different embryos to suit external conditions.
- (D) thin-shelled cysts when temperatures are extreme.

31. What type of brine shrimp is shown in the diagram below?



- (A) juvenile female
- (B) juvenile male
- (C) adult male
- (D) adult female

32. Why have the hands been included in the photograph?

- (A) to give an idea of the size of brine shrimp
- (B) to show that brine shrimp like to swim together
- (C) to illustrate the role of humans in the brine shrimp's life cycle
- (D) to illustrate the different types of brine shrimp a human can find

They have cut down the pines

They have cut down the pines where they stood;
The wind will miss them—the rain,
When its silver blind is down.
They have stripped the bark from the wood—
5 The needly boughs, and the brown
Knobbly nuts trodden into the ground.
The kind, the friendly trees,
Where all day small winds sound,
And all day long the sun
10 Plays hide and seek with shadows
Till the multiplying shadows turn to one
And night is here.

They have cut down the trees and ended now
The gentle colloquy* of bough and bough.
15 They are making a fence by the creek,
And have cut down the pines for the posts.
Wan in the sunlight as ghosts
The naked trunks lie.
A bird nested there—it will seek
20 In vain: they have cut down the pines.

Mary Lisle

* A colloquy is a conversation.

33. What does the quotation 'When its silver blind is down' describe?
- (A) a lightning storm
 - (B) closed windows
 - (C) a grey cloud
 - (D) heavy rain
34. Which quotation shows that people or animals walked among the trees?
- (A) 'The wind will miss them' (line 2)
 - (B) 'Knobbly nuts trodden into the ground' (line 6)
 - (C) 'The kind, the friendly trees' (line 7)
 - (D) 'the sun / Plays hide and seek with shadows' (lines 9–10)
35. The poet uses the phrase 'The gentle colloquy of bough and bough' to describe
- (A) the falling of the pine needles.
 - (B) the breaking of branches.
 - (C) the noise of the branches.
 - (D) the growth of trees.
36. Why were the pine trees cut down?
- (A) to stop the birds from nesting
 - (B) to reduce noise pollution
 - (C) to allow more sunlight through
 - (D) to make the posts for a fence
37. In what way are the chopped trees like ghosts?
- (A) They can only be seen at night.
 - (B) They are not alive anymore.
 - (C) They do not have shadows.
 - (D) They appear to be transparent.
38. Which word best describes the tone of the poem?
- (A) regret
 - (B) anger
 - (C) disgust
 - (D) shame

Active kids learn better

Do active kids learn better? Canadian researcher Dr Rachel Colley thinks so. She believes that students in active schools can improve not only their grades, but also their attention in class, thinking skills, and general health simply by exercising more often. And she is not the only one to come to this conclusion.

Active schools are so called because they deliberately include physical activity as part of their school day. I observed a class in one such school. Students were about to change to a different subject when the teacher, Mr Robertson, used a few prompts that were obviously part of the classroom routine. The students quickly assembled by the door. 'How long, Mr Robertson?' they chorused happily. Mr Robertson consulted the class fitness chart for the week and replied, 'Five minutes of running on the athletics field.' And off they went, without fuss.

Teachers in active schools explained that they often joined in the exercises, encouraging students who needed a prod to keep going, and helping all to set their own running goals. So what did Mr Robertson and his colleagues expect from this? The teachers said that in the short term, students demonstrated more on-task time, more energy for learning, more confidence and less misbehaviour. In the long term, they hoped for healthy, happy children who worked hard to achieve learning goals.

Dr Colley would agree. In fact, the research is so compelling that in 2005, the government of Ontario, Canada, required schools to include at least 20 minutes of physical activity every day. More recent research continues to support this link between physical activity and academic performance. A 2015 study of students in grades 4 to 6 from 18 schools in Nova Scotia, Canada, found that students who had lower levels of physical activity were more likely to have lower scores in mathematics and English language arts.

But what if it's not convenient to go outside? Should students jog while they learn their multiplication tables and skip while they read how to design a paper aeroplane? A 2016 study of students in grades 2 and 3 in 12 schools in the Netherlands actually did something like that. The researchers developed a program called *Fit & Vaardig op School* (Fit and Academically Proficient at School) which used physical exercise to teach mathematics and language. For example, students hopped 8 times to solve '2 x 4'. They found that after two school years, the active students gained four months of learning over the students in traditional classrooms in speed mathematics, mathematics skills and spelling.

Sometimes simple solutions yield great results.



39. What does the word 'compelling' mean?
 (A) trustworthy (B) convincing (C) new (D) accurate
40. 'A 2015 study of students in grades 4 to 6 from 18 schools in Nova Scotia, Canada, found that students who had lower levels of physical activity were more likely to have lower scores in mathematics and English language arts.'
 Which of the following could be placed in front of the sentence so that it links it to the rest of the paragraph?
 (A) Therefore, (B) Finally, (C) In addition, (D) For example,
41. 'Should students jog while they learn their multiplication tables and skip while they read how to design a paper aeroplane?'
 What is unusual about the tone of the sentence?
 (A) The writer seems like she is interested in the topic but is actually not.
 (B) The writer seems like she is praising the idea but is actually criticising it.
 (C) The writer sounds like she has made up her mind but is actually undecided.
 (D) The writer sounds like she is joking about the idea but is actually serious.
42. How is the *Fit & Vaardig op School* program different from other active school programs?
 (A) Students must use the program for two years.
 (B) There are more than 10 schools involved.
 (C) Students learn through exercise.
 (D) The students are in primary school.
43. The last paragraph only has one sentence. The text ends with a short paragraph because
 (A) the writer wants to emphasise the statement.
 (B) the writer has run out of ideas.
 (C) the writer wants to prove the program works.
 (D) the writer wants to create a sense of urgency.
44. Which piece of evidence from the text best supports the idea that active schools are effective?
 (A) that Mr Robertson included physical activity in his class
 (B) that Dr Rachel Colley believes that active schools help students to learn
 (C) that active students gained four months of learning over students in traditional classrooms
 (D) that teachers were willing to join their students in exercising
45. What is the main purpose of the text?
 (A) to encourage teachers to become more active
 (B) to stress the importance of improving maths and English scores
 (C) to give examples of fitness activities for students
 (D) to persuade schools to include physical activity every day

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

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SOURCES

Page 10 Image of Walker, age 14, with a hand full of brine shrimp scooped from the waters of Mono Lake, California. Photographed by Kevin Knauss.

Page 12 "They have cut down the pines" poem by Mary Lisle © Mary Lisle

Page 14 Active kids image © Floresco Productions/Cultura RF/imagefolk

THE FOLLOWING YEAR LEVELS SHOULD SIT THIS PAPER:

Australia	Year 3
Brunei	Primary 3
Hong Kong	Primary 3
Indian Subcontinent¹	Class 3
Indonesia	Year 4
Malaysia	Standard 3
Middle East²	Class 3
New Zealand/Pacific³	Year 4
Singapore	Primary 2
Southern Africa⁴	Grade 3

1 Indian Subcontinent Region: India, Sri Lanka, Nepal, Bhutan and Bangladesh.

2 Middle East Region: United Arab Emirates, Qatar, Kuwait, Saudi Arabia, Egypt, Bahrain, Oman, Turkey, Lebanon, Tunisia, Morocco, Libya, Algeria and Jordan.

3 Pacific Region: Vanuatu, Papua New Guinea and Fiji.

4 Southern Africa Region: South Africa, Botswana, Lesotho, Swaziland, Zimbabwe and Namibia.

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AUSTRALIA

ANALYSIS BY QUESTION

The following table shows the questions you answered correctly ☒ and shades the questions that you answered incorrectly ☐. The questions are ranked from hardest at the top to easiest at the bottom.

	Question content	Area assessed	Question number	Correct answer
Difficult Questions	Infer the tone of a poem	Text comprehension	38	A
	Interpret a reference using figurative language in a poem	Text comprehension	33	D
	Examine an argument to select the best evidence to support a claim	Text comprehension	44	C
	Understand figurative language in a poem	Writer's craft	35	C
	Explain key information in a scientific text	Text comprehension	30	C
	Understand a paragraph to identify a clarifying connective to add to a sentence	Syntax	40	D
	Identify specific information in a scientific text	Text comprehension	28	C
	Explain the purpose of a short concluding paragraph in an argument	Writer's craft	43	A
	Analyse a poem to find evidence of an action	Text comprehension	34	B
	Interpret the meaning of a word in an argument: compelling	Vocabulary	39	B
	Evaluate a sentence to determine its tone in an argument	Writer's craft	41	D
	Identify alliteration in a narrative	Writer's craft	15	B
	Interpret the meaning of a word from its context in a factual text: widespread	Vocabulary	9	A
	Analyse a narrative to draw a conclusion about which event occurred	Text comprehension	17	A
	Make an inference from information in a scientific text and show it on a diagram	Text comprehension	27	C
	Analyse an argument to state its main purpose	Text comprehension	45	D
	Compare examples given in an argument	Text comprehension	42	C
	Locate specific information in facts accompanying a narrative	Text comprehension	18	B
	Identify the use of italics to show a scientific name in a factual text	Syntax	10	C
	Identify a sub-heading in a scientific text	Writer's craft	29	A
	Explain figurative language in a poem	Writer's craft	37	B
	Identify the correct auxiliary verb to complete a passage	Syntax	24	A
	Identify key information in a poem	Text comprehension	36	D
	Interpret the meaning of a word in a passage: exhilarating	Vocabulary	22	B
	Interpret the purpose of including hands in a photograph to indicate size	Writer's craft	32	A
	Interpret the meaning of a word in a factual text: enjoyed	Vocabulary	12	B
	Interpret information in a factual text to identify the cause of a phenomenon	Text comprehension	13	C
	Interpret a factual text to determine the purpose for asking a question	Writer's craft	7	C
	Identify a noun in a description in a factual text	Syntax	8	D
	Match information to a diagram in a scientific text	Text comprehension	31	B
	Interpret the meaning of a word in a passage: swept	Vocabulary	21	A
	Interpret the meaning of a word in a passage: Startled	Vocabulary	20	D
	Identify specific information in a scientific text	Text comprehension	26	B
	Recognise a reference to a goal in a fable	Syntax	4	A
	Locate specific information in a factual text	Text comprehension	11	D
	Infer characters' feelings from their body language in a fable	Text comprehension	5	C
	Identify the correct preposition to complete a passage	Syntax	23	B
	Analyse a fable to determine vital information	Text comprehension	6	A
Easy Questions	Understand what characters in a narrative are referring to	Text comprehension	16	D
	Identify a comparison in a fable	Writer's craft	3	C
	Use personal experience to draw a conclusion about characters in a narrative	Text comprehension	14	D
	Understand the purpose of factual information in a multi-genre text	Text comprehension	19	A
	Identify the correct conjunction to complete a passage	Syntax	25	B
	Locate the reason for characters' actions in a fable	Text comprehension	2	D
	Match an image to a character in a fable	Text comprehension	1	B